

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 22, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 44:15-31

15 "But the priests, the Levites, the sons of Zadok, who kept charge of My sanctuary when the children of Israel went astray from Me, they shall come near Me to minister to Me; and they shall stand before Me to offer to Me the fat and the blood," says the Lord God.

16 "They shall enter My sanctuary, and they shall come near My table to minister to Me, and they shall keep My charge.

17 And it shall be, whenever they enter the gates of the inner court, that they shall put on linen garments; no wool shall come upon them while they minister within the gates of the inner court or within the house.

18 They shall have linen turbans on their heads and linen trousers on their bodies; they shall not clothe themselves with anything that causes sweat.

19 When they go out to the outer court, to the outer court to the people, they shall take off their garments in which they have ministered, leave them in the holy chambers, and put on other garments; and in their holy garments they shall not sanctify the people.

20 "They shall neither shave their heads nor let their hair grow long, but they shall keep their hair well trimmed.

21 No priest shall drink wine when he enters the inner court.

22 They shall not take as wife a widow or a divorced woman, but take virgins of the descendants of the house of Israel, or widows of priests.

23 "And they shall teach My people the difference between the holy and the unholy, and cause them to discern between the unclean and the clean.

24 In controversy they shall stand as judges, and judge it according to My judgments. They shall keep My laws and My statutes in all My appointed meetings, and they shall hallow My Sabbaths.

25 "They shall not defile themselves by coming near a dead person. Only for father or

mother, for son or daughter, for brother or unmarried sister may they defile themselves.

26 After he is cleansed, they shall count seven days for him.

27 And on the day that he goes to the sanctuary to minister in the sanctuary, he must offer his sin offering in the inner court," says the Lord God.

28 "It shall be, in regard to their inheritance, that I am their inheritance. You shall give them no possession in Israel, for I am their possession.

29 They shall eat the grain offering, the sin offering, and the trespass offering; every dedicated thing in Israel shall be theirs.

30 The best of all firstfruits of any kind, and every sacrifice of any kind from all your sacrifices, shall be the priest's; also you shall give to the priest the first of your ground meal, to cause a blessing to rest on your house.

31 The priests shall not eat anything, bird or beast, that died naturally or was torn by wild beasts.

II. Key Summary

- God appoints the sons of Zadok as priests because they kept charge of His sanctuary when the rest of Israel went astray from Him; they are the ones who may come near God, enter His sanctuary, and minister at His table (vv. 15-16).
 - God gives detailed instructions about the priests' clothing, hair, wine, marriage, and contact with the dead, and tells them to teach the people the difference between the holy and the unholy, the clean and the unclean, and to judge disputes according to His judgments (vv. 17-27).
 - God says the priests are to be given no possession in Israel, because "I am their inheritance"; their living comes from the grain offering, the sin offering, the trespass offering, and the firstfruits the people bring (vv. 28-31).
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III. Passage Analysis

How Faithful You Are Decides How Much You Are Trusted With

"The Levites were given the office of serving in the temple, but because they were the

first to fall into idolatry, they were disqualified from holding that office; their work now is to guard the gates and slaughter the sacrifices. Whoever is faithful in small things will be put in charge of great things; whoever is unfaithful in great things is left with only small things." [1]

The Levites who went astray are kept out at the temple gates (vv. 10-14, yesterday's portion). The sons of Zadok are Levites too, and in vv. 15-16 they may enter the sanctuary, come near God's table to minister, and "keep My charge."

Everyone Else Got Land; the Levites Got God

"The priests' inheritance was not land, but God Himself. When the land was divided in Joshua's day, every other tribe received its portion; only the Levites received no land, because God is their inheritance. This means God takes personal responsibility for how they live." [2]

In v. 28 God says, "You shall give them no possession in Israel, for I am their possession," and vv. 29-30 then list what they actually live on: the grain offering, the sin offering, the trespass offering, and the people's firstfruits.

IV. Reflection Question

If someone asked you, "What is the place God has given you right now?" — how would you answer?

In v. 15 God is the one who speaks first: "they shall come near Me to minister to Me." The place was given to the sons of Zadok, not chosen by them. According to 1 Peter 2:5, 9, every believer today is a priest to God, and that service is aimed first not at people, but at God Himself. [3]

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (ccbiblestudy), Grace Bible Commentary (聖經精讀本), Notes on Ezekiel 44:10,
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT44.htm>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (ccbiblestudy), Grace Bible Commentary (聖經精讀本), Notes on Ezekiel 44:28,
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT44.htm>

[3] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Ezekiel 44 (note on Ezekiel 44:15),
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-44/>